

293 Meeting and Event Planning Concepts (Open)

(formerly 590)

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate understanding of the core principles and practices of professional meeting and event management. This objective test reflects industry-informed standards and emphasizes ethical conduct, effective communication, and appropriate use of technology. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this objective event.

Contestant Must Supply

- (Optional) Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified.

Contest Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Reference materials are not allowed. Contestants who violate this rule will be disqualified.
- Length of event: no more than sixty (60) minutes testing time
- Unlimited entries by state

Contest Competencies

1. Plan and manage all aspects of an event project by organizing tasks, timelines, and resources
2. Recruit, schedule, and train staff or volunteers to support event operations
3. Manage the event budget by tracking expenses, handling monetary transactions, and making cost-effective decisions
4. Demonstrate knowledge of event design principles by planning the theme, program, agenda, room layout, speakers, performers, and key activities
5. Coordinate food, beverage, and vendor services according to event needs and expectations
6. Plan attendee flow and manage the event site by selecting an appropriate venue, designing the layout, and ensuring efficient movement and operations
7. Develop and manage event communication materials, including marketing pieces, signage, and merchandise
8. Communicate clearly and professionally in written and verbal business interactions
9. Demonstrate professionalism by acting responsibly, ethically, respectfully, and with transparency
10. Identify potential risks and develop basic contingency plans for unexpected challenges
11. Apply sustainable and socially responsible practices in meeting and event planning when appropriate
12. Evaluate event success using attendee feedback, budget outcomes, and key performance indicators

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